Mothers' Behaviour and Barriers in Early Childhood Sexuality Education

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Introduction

Child sexual abuse (CSA) affects 18% of girls and 7.6% of boys worldwide. In Indonesia, over 14,000 cases in 2022 highlight the need for prevention. Early sexuality education helps reduce CSA risk, but cultural taboos and parental discomfort limit delivery. Mothers' key roles remain underexplored in Indonesia.

Objective

This study aimed to explore how mothers provide sexuality education to young children and to identify the factors and barriers that influence their behavior.

Methods

Study design: Descriptive Analytical Survey

Location: Sawangan, Magelang, Central Java
January–March 2025

Dependent variable: mothers behavior in delivering sexuality education
Independent variables: intention to provide sexuality education, self-efficacy, attitude, perception, communication barriers, and husband's support.

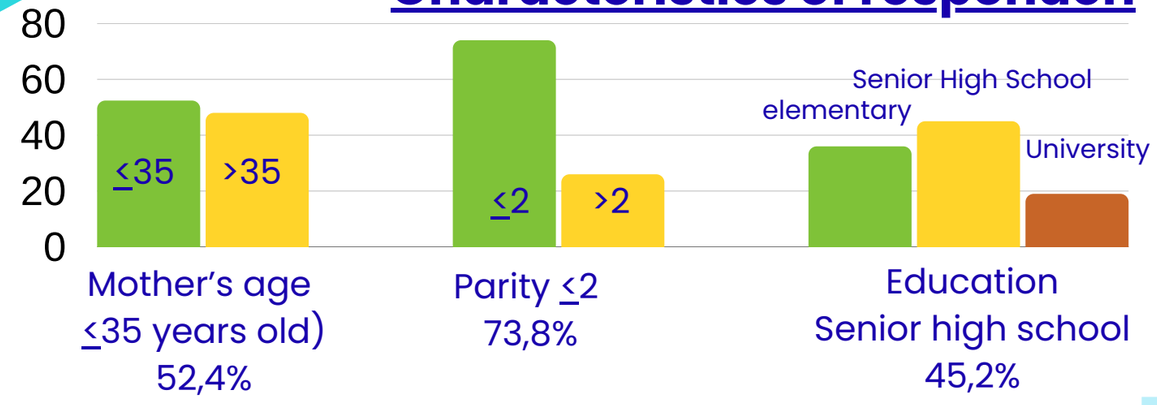
Tools
Validated, reliable Questionnare

Participants:
42 mothers of kindergarten students randomly selected from 42 schools

Data Analysis:
Frequency distribution
Path analysis

Result

Characteristics of responden



Sexuality Education

Behavior

Often (score>60%)
Family, Refuse violence, body parts, personal higiene

Sometimes (score 40-60%)
Male and female difference, sexual violence

Rarely (score 20-40%)
Pregnancy and delivery

Barrier

Agree (>60%)
Awkward, incapable, worried, uncomfortable

Strongly agree (score >80%)
worry, prefer whet they get older

Path analysis interpretation

Intention directly increased mothers' behavior (0.49), driven by self-efficacy (0.71). Perception and attitude improved self-efficacy (0.56; 0.53), perception enhanced attitude (0.52), barriers reduced self-efficacy (−0.32), and husband's support lowered barriers (−0.54).

Conclusion

This study found that mothers' intention strongly influenced by self efficacy was the main predictor of sexuality education behavior, while husband's support reduced barriers. It extends the Theory of Planned Behavior and highlights the need for family-based interventions that build mothers' confidence, address barriers, and involve fathers.

Refference

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